

know more than the characters within the story world.

- Binary oppositions function as a narrative element including good vs evil, police vs criminal as well as, in the case of *The Bridge*, the cultural differences of Sweden vs Denmark, Saga vs Hanne, the nuclear vs the non-nuclear family and illusion vs reality. The resolving of some of these binary oppositions within the story world may have an ideological significance, for example evil being punished and justice prevailing in a crime drama (**Structuralism: Levi-Strauss**).
- Plot situations are included that are typical of the crime genre. For example, the discovery of a body, an arrest, an interview with a suspect or the denouement where the perpetrator of the crime is revealed by the detective. These situations are made slightly different in *The Bridge* due to the incongruencies in Saga's character. For example, in the interview with the victim's wife Saga has to be prevented from showing her the crime scene photographs.
- Story arcs and narrative strands occur in episodes and across the series of a crime drama. In *The Bridge*, as this is the first episode of a new series, there are several complex, enigmatic narrative strands, some new and some carrying over from other series, which will be interwoven across the episodes in this series, including:
 - Saga's past and her involvement with Martin, her role in this narrative and how she relates to others, her past and her mother
 - The partnerships and team dynamics, for example Hanne Thomsen and Lillian and the tension with the Saga and the Swedish team
 - The crime – who killed Helle Anker? The enigma of the murder scene set up as a nuclear family.
 - The additional storylines including the role of Aleksandr and his place in the narrative
 - The character of Henrik, his drug dependence and the enigma surrounding his family. The expectation of how he and Saga will work together.
- **Stock characters** usually including a hierarchy with a boss, a detective, a sidekick, and other characters, for example a victim, a range of suspects, the perpetrator of the crime and experts/witnesses who help in the solving of the

crime. Often the pairing of characters are binary opposites, and their relationships contribute to tensions within the narrative, this is the case with Saga and firstly Hanne and then potentially Henrik.

- **Setting and locations.** These will become synonymous with the programme and the brand and will relate to characters and the sub-genre. Some settings will be typical of the genre, for example the police station, the post-mortem lab and urban crime settings, others become iconic, for example the bridge.

Theoretical Approach: Narratology - Todorov

- All narratives share a basic structure involving movement from one state of equilibrium to another, separated by a disequilibrium. The opening of *The Bridge* establishes an initial **equilibrium**, Martin is now in jail, Saga is focused on work and Pettersen and Lillian are married.
- The **disruption** to this equilibrium is the discovery of the body of Helle Anker. **Enigma codes** are then established as a key element of the narrative in the attempt to find the killer.
- A series of story arcs are established which interweave across the episode.
- As this is an example of an episodic drama there would not be a resolution at the end of the first episode, instead there is a **cliffhanger** with an explosion where Hanne is seriously injured and the introduction of Henrik as Saga's new partner. The audience has been placed in a privileged spectator position regarding Henrik's situation which foreshadows possible future narratives.

How genre conventions are socially and historically relative, dynamic and can be used in a hybrid way

- Although genres have never been stagnant, it is increasingly the case that they are more dynamic and seek to challenge audience expectations. The genre now is a starting point to target the audience and then surprise them through hybridity and intertextuality.
- Some programmes, for example *The Bridge*, challenge and subvert genre conventions, in this case through the narrative, the characters and reference to other genres. The **Nordic Noir** crime dramas demonstrate their hybridity through reference to the conventions of film noir many, but not all of which are evident in *The Bridge*:
 - A dark, pessimistic tone and mood
 - Chiaroscuro lighting and shadows establishing enigma codes and a bleak melancholy aesthetic